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PERSONAL PROFILE

Principal Lead Frontend Developer at Acorn Group, leading a growing team of 15+ engineers and overseeing frontend engineering across seven squads. As the group has grown, my remit has expanded from frontend delivery to shared standards, technical direction and engineering development across multiple insurance brands

KEY SKILLS

Core Skills

- Engineering leadership: multi-squad technical direction, engineering standards, mentoring, career progression, training plans and one-to-ones.
- Frontend architecture: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Module Federation, microfrontends, Vite, UI libraries and private npm packages.
- Mobile engineering: React Native, Expo, Maestro and native bridge integration.
- Testing and quality: Vitest, Playwright, React Testing Library, Jest, TDD and BDD.
- Platforms and backend: Node.js, GraphQL, Azure, AWS, Docker, NGINX, .NET, SQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB and MySQL.
- AI-assisted development: Claude and Cursor.

WORK EXPERIENCE AND EMPLOYMENT

- **Acorn Insurance (Acorn Group)** **2023 – Present**
  Tech Stack: React, NextJS, React Native, TypeScript, Module Federation, Vite, Vitest, Playwright, Expo, Maestro, Azure, .NET
  Job Title: Principal Lead Frontend Developer (previously Lead Front-End Software Engineer)
  Lead a growing team of 15+ engineers across seven squads supporting the Acorn Group's insurance brands. As the business has expanded, my responsibilities have grown to cover cross-squad technical decisions, shared engineering practices and colleague development.
    - Set and enforce frontend engineering standards across squads, covering architecture, code quality, testing and shared tooling.
    - Guide technical decisions across web and mobile projects for different insurance brands, helping squads use consistent approaches as the group grows.
    - Introduced Module Federation to support microfrontend architecture across frontend applications.
    - Introduced Vite, Vitest and Playwright into frontend projects to give squads common build and testing tools.
    - Led React development for a car insurance quote-and-buy journey, including tests built with React Testing Library.
    - Introduced a React Native taxi app, with further mobile applications in development across squads.
    - Used Expo and Maestro for mobile development and testing, with a custom internal npm package that provides access to native bridge functionality.

- Building an internal UI library with designers and engineers to standardise components and avoid repeated work across squads.
- Built a scoped npm package containing reusable solutions and published it through a private registry for other squads.
- Support adoption of Claude and Cursor and use both tools in my own development work.
- Work with engineers, designers and stakeholders to turn business requirements into technical solutions across Acorn Group brands.
- Introduced individual progression and training plans for colleagues in 2026. Use one-to-ones to agree goals, review progress and identify development needs.

- **Players' Lounge** **2022 – 2023**
  Tech Stack: React (NextJS), React-Native, TypeScript, GraphQL (Apollo), Bitrise, NodeJS, Elixir, AWS, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
  Job Title: Senior Front-End Software Engineer
  - Working across multiple projects building stable and maintainable apps using React & React Native in TypeScript.
  - Successfully developed an MVP application in 3 months for a Peerless wagering application that allows you to bet on yourself in the ESports and gaming industry.
  - Working as part of a cross-functional team, both onshore and offshore, made up of designers, engineers and product owners, using Kanban to deliver various projects.

- **Acorn Insurance** **2021 – 2022**
  Tech Stack: React, TypeScript, Azure, .Net, SQL, MongoDB
  Job Title: Lead Front-End Software Engineer
  - Built and maintained React and TypeScript applications across several projects.
  - Developed a quote-and-buy application for private car insurance.
  - Worked with engineers, designers, product owners and client stakeholders on technical solutions to business requirements.

- **Fourth wall creative** **2019 – 2021**
  Tech Stack: React, Typescript, Github, Laravel, PostgreSQL
  Job Title: Software Engineer
  - Built ticketing and event management software for Premier League football clubs.
  - Worked with engineers, designers, product owners and club representatives across different departments.
  - Built a package fulfilment application that helped clubs track product distribution to members and record satisfaction.

- **Nova Ltd** **2017 – 2019**
  Tech Stack: React, React Native, TypeScript, Bitbucket, .Net, SQL
  Job Title: Software Engineer
  - Built digital products with entrepreneurs and internal venture teams using lean delivery methods.
  - Delivered projects with onshore and offshore engineers, designers and product owners using Scrum and Kanban.
  - Developed and released DLG Inventory, DLG Spellbook, UMII and Thrift on app stores. Also worked on DLG Dungeon Master, Play-back, Teacherfolio and Medsee web projects.

- Managed the 2018 to 2019 recruitment of software engineering interns, including assessments and interviews, then supervised their development and training.

- **CyberGaTE, Edge Hill University** **2015 - 2017**
  Job Title: Game Developer
  Duties: Creating a gamification game based on cyber security using Unity 3D and C# to develop the game. I am also the lead manager of the Game development team.

- **Morrison's, Ormskirk** **2015 - 2016**
  Job Title: Night Staff
  Duties: Restock shelves in the frozen and fresh food department; clean and tidy the chiller and freezer.

- **Edge Hill University** **2015 - 2015**
  Job Title: Student Assistant
  Duties: helping children who were looking at Edge Hill University for their higher education. It involved me to help show the children how to use a program called Unity 3D which is a Development Program.

EDUCATION

- **Edge Hill University 2014 – 2019**
  MCOMP Computing First-Class
  - **Modules**
    Programming Concepts to Construction, Programming Languages: Theory to Practice, Intelligent Systems, Game Engines, Embedded Systems, Computer Graphics & Modelling, Digital Design & Production, Mobile Apps, System Penetration Testing, Team Projects, Computer Systems in a Digital World, Distributed Systems, Foundations of Computer Science, Advanced Database, Research Methods, Project Management, Application Development with Java, Interface Programming, Research & Development Project
  - **Projects**
    Cyber Gate (Gamification Cyber Security), 48 Hour Global Game Jam 2017 (Grape Wars), Barclays Tech Challenge 2016 (1st place), ROQ IT Defectives University Challenge, University Tech Challenge (1st place)
- **St Helens College 2009 - 2014**
  - BTEC I.C. T Level 3 D*D*D*
  - BTEC Health and Social Care Level 2 Merit
- **Higher Side Comprehensive School 2004 - 2009**
  - GCSE Graded B – D including Math and English
  - BTEC Science Grade C

INTERESTS

I enjoy playing on my guitar, working on my computer and creating games in unity and going out socialising with my friends I also enjoy going to the gym and trying to push myself to reach new limits.